FILM

# Earning His ACTING CHOPS

**HIS LATEST STINT IN *THE BUCKINGHAM MURDERS*, WHICH JUST RELEASED ON NETFLIX, CEMENTS THE MULTI-HYPHENATE RANVEER BRAR'S REPUTATION AS A FINE ACTOR**

Whether he's been leading you to the most mouthwatering feasts in India in *The Great Indian Rasoi*, or charming contestants and viewers as the feisty judge on *Masterchef India*, or sharing rare recipes on his YouTube channel, Chef Ranveer Brar's face is by now a familiar presence.

And yet, the 'Food Sufi', as he calls himself, is now following his soul down a different path. In 2022, we saw him essaying an LGBTQ+ character in the *Modern Love Mumbai* anthology on Amazon Prime. Now he's gone full-on Bollywood, playing one of the leads in *The Buckingham Murders* opposite Kareena Kapoor. "The response has been outstanding. A lot of people who watched it were surprised to see me there. Since then, I've got calls from a lot of senior directors and film critics, which is heartwarming. But what really stood out for me was that my mom wouldn't get off the seat in the auditorium after the movie!" Needless to say, Brar is visibly chuffed.

It was Mukesh Chhabra, casting director, filmmaker and actor, who called to tell him there was a role in TBM and that director Hansal Mehta (who had directed *Baai*, the MLM episode with Brar in it) only wanted him. Brar says, "I don't say no to Hansal sir. I hadn't even read the script, but I agreed. Only later did I realise the film was with Kareena (Kapoor)! Everybody said I had to be doubly pre-

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JOHAN PERSSON

THEATRE

# BON VOYAGE

The award-winning stage adaptation of Yann Martel's *Life of Pi* is coming to Mumbai this December

The internationally acclaimed *Life of Pi* production is set to make its Indian debut at the Nita Mukesh Ambani Cultural Centre (NMACC) in Mumbai. Directed by Max Webster and adapted by Lolita Chakrabarti, this stage adaptation of Yann Martel's Booker Prize-winning novel has captivated audiences worldwide with its breath-taking puppetry, innovative set design and profound storytelling.

The narrative follows 16-year-old Pi